JAN SURAAJ OVERSEAS

Member Orientation Guide

Uniting the Bihari Diaspora Worldwide

🌍 **Global**

Non-Profit Org

🍁 **Registered**

Canada (Not-for-Profit)

🗳️ **Democratic**

Elected Leadership

WHO WE ARE

MISSION

- Unite and mobilize the Bihari diaspora worldwide
- Promote social welfare, economic development, education & human rights
- Facilitate cultural exchange and collaborations
- Advocate for Bihar socio-economic development
- Operate strictly as a non-political, not-for-profit organization

WHO CAN JOIN?

- Age 18+ of Bihar origin living outside India
- Friends & supporters of Bihar development residing outside India
- No criminal conviction (or fully pardoned)
- Submit a membership application in prescribed form
- Application approved by the Global Council

Membership Fee: CAD $25/year | Fee waived for members joining until December 2025

ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

TIER 1

Global Council (GC)

21 voting members + advisors
Governing the entire JSO worldwide

TIER 2

7 Regional Councils (RC)

5 voting members per region
North/South America, Europe, Middle East, Africa, Asia, Oceania

TIER 3

National Councils (NC)

11 voting members per country
One council per country where JSO is active

TIER 4

Chapter Councils (CC)

5 voting members per chapter
Local chapters within each country

Members automatically belong to their local Chapter, National, Regional & Global councils based on residence

GLOBAL COUNCIL — KEY ROLES

EXECUTIVE OFFICERS

- President
- Vice President
- General Secretary
- Joint Secretary
- Treasurer

SECRETARIES & VPs

- 7 Regional Vice Presidents
- Secretary – Public Relations & Media
- Secretary – Membership & Outreach
- Secretary – Legal & Elections
- Secretary – Fund Raising
- Secretary – Communications & IT
- Secretary – Events Management
- Secretary – Research & Innovation

STANDING COMMITTEES:

Executive • Finance • Governance • Disciplinary • JSP Communication & Coordination • Election & Nomination

MEETINGS & QUORUM RULES

Global Council

- Meets at least once per month
- Reviews reports from all committees
- 50% quorum of voting members required
- Annual General Body Meeting — once a year within 6 months of fiscal year end

Meeting Notices

- Annual/General meetings: 3 weeks advance notice (max 30 days)
- Council meetings: 7 days advance notice
- Extraordinary meetings: within 21 days of request
- Special GC meetings: within 30 days of request

Voting Rules

- Simple majority decides most matters
- 2/3 majority required for removals & bylaw amendments
- Proxy voting is NOT permitted
- President casts tie-breaking vote

Attendance

- 3 consecutive unexcused absences triggers a notice
- Further 2 missed meetings may result in removal
- Elections: secret ballot (online or in-person)

TERMS, ELECTIONS & YOUR RIGHTS

TERMS & ELECTIONS

- Each council member serves a 3-year term
- Maximum 2 consecutive terms in the same position
- Exceptions require 2/3 General Body vote
- Election & Nomination Committee manages all elections
- Applications must be submitted 10 business days before the general meeting
- Voting is secret: online or in-person
- Tied vote resolved by Chair of the General Meeting

MEMBER RIGHTS & CONDUCT

- One vote per member at global, branch and chapter general body meetings
- Eligible to elect Global/Regional/National/Chapter council representatives
- Right to appeal any membership revocation decision
- Code of conduct violations may result in removal via Disciplinary Committee
- Membership termination requires 2/3 majority GC vote
- Bylaw amendments require 2/3 GC majority and 6 weeks advance notice to all members
- All rights cease upon membership termination

WELCOME TO JSO!

Together, we build a stronger Bihar from across the globe.

- 💳 Membership Fee: CAD $25/year (waived until Dec 2025)
- 🗓️ Stay engaged — attend General Body meetings annually
- 🌐 You are part of a 4-tier global network — your voice matters
- 📋 Refer to the full JSO Constitution for all authoritative details